



Office of  
Deputy Commissioner  
of Maritime Affairs

## THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA

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#### **TECHNICAL LETTER 2025-03** **05 September 2025** **(supersedes Technical Letter 2006-01 (rev.1), dated September 21, 2006)**

#### **Subject: Ship Maneuverability Requirements**

This technical letter is issued to detail the Administration's policy with regards to ship maneuverability requirements and IMO Resolution. A.601(15).

#### **Policy:**

Liberia requires that the maneuvering information be displayed on the bridge as required by IMO Res. A.601(15). However, Liberia does not require that vessels registered under the Liberian flag be supplied with a maneuvering booklet. Liberian flag vessels need only be supplied with the Wheelhouse Poster and the Pilot Card required by IMO Resolution A.601(15). Only the Wheelhouse Poster needs to be permanently displayed on the bridge. The Pilot Card should be available on the bridge for use by the pilot but does not have to be displayed.

It should be noted that vessels trading to the U.S. may be required by the USCG to have a maneuvering booklet to operate in U.S. waters. The vessel owners should be aware that even though Liberia may not require a maneuvering booklet the USCG may require one before the vessels will be able to call upon U.S. ports and offshore loading facilities.

If a vessel's owners voluntarily decide to obtain the maneuvering booklet mentioned in A.601(15), the booklet needs only to be available on board vessel and does not have to be displayed on the bridge. While most of the maneuvering information in the booklet can be estimated, the shipowner and shipyard should work with the vessel's classification society to determine what information should be determined at sea trial.

In the event a ship is unable to satisfy any of the maneuvering criteria mentioned in A.601(15) by the measured value at sea trial, the shipowner and shipyard should work with the vessel's classification society to develop alternative procedures for satisfying the criteria.

IMO Resolution A. 751(18), Interim Standards for Ship Maneuvering, is not mandatory for Liberia flag vessels.

If necessary, warning signs are to be provided, displayed on the maneuvering poster indicating any exceedance of criteria in resolution 137(76), e.g.:

1. The advance/tactical diameter exceeds [number] ship lengths
2. With the [number] degree zig zag test, the travel distance is [number] ship lengths by the time the heading has changed [number] ship lengths by the time the heading has changed by [number] from the original heading

The Administration will allow the maneuvering test required by IMO Resolution A.601(15) to be carried out on the lead vessel in a series and waive the requirement for sister vessels of the same dimensions and fitted with a main engine of the same power, and the same size propeller and rudder.

In cases where the SHaPoLi / EPL system is applied, the following documents should be updated to include the maneuvering characteristics of the ship when the ship has all shaft and engine power available, and when shaft or engine power has been limited:

- .1 the Pilot card;
- .2 the wheelhouse poster; and
- .3 the maneuvering booklet.

In case no corresponding trials are carried out, alternately, the existing maneuvering booklet, if available, and the maneuvering chart/poster displayed in the wheelhouse may include that the ship's power has been limited and state the limiting power for the attention of the Master to account for the ship's performance.

Ships with non-overridable shaft-engine power limitation need to be provided with new maneuvering charts/posters in the wheelhouse. Any ship's certificates that refer to engine (propulsion) power should be reissued to indicate the limited engine power

Computational fluid dynamics may be used to prepare the revised/new maneuvering charts/posters.

If you have any questions on this Technical Letter, please contact [Regsandstandards@liscr.com](mailto:Regsandstandards@liscr.com).

Regards,

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